Sayorn Chin

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Last Update: November 2, 2026

Visa Status **Cambodia:** Citizenship, **United States:** Permanent Resident

Current Positions

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Lafayette College — Jul. 2023 – Present
Data Science Fellow Affiliate, Mountain Data Group — Jun. 2023 – Present

Previous Positions

Data Scientist, Mountain Data Group — May 2021 – May 2023
Graduate Teaching Instructor, Colorado State University — Jul. 2020 – May 2023
Graduate Teaching Assistant, Colorado State University — Aug. 2017 – May 2020
Finance Assistant, Colorado College — Feb. 2016 – Jan. 2017
Data Research Analyst, Colorado College — Jan. 2016 – May 2016

Education

Ph.D., Economics, Colorado State University — 2023
M.A., Economics, Colorado State University — 2019
B.A., Mathematical Economics, Colorado College — 2017

Research Output

Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics

[1] Chin, S., Zahran, S., Keyes, C., & Mushinski, D. (2026). The longer reach of lead: Early childhood lead exposure and cognitive ability later-in-life. *Economics and Human Biology*, 101663.

[2] Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2026). Beyond income: Health, wealth, and racial welfare gaps among older Americans. *Demography*, *63*(1), 187–211.

[3] An, Y., Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2025). Growing old in rural America: Measuring late-life health and economic well-being. *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, *31*, 100565.

[4] Miller, R., Chin, S., & Sedai, A. K. (2022). The welfare cost of late-life depression. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *204*, 15–36.

Peer-Reviewed Publications: Public Health

[1] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). The unregulated rise of kratom drinks: Emerging challenges and policy recommendations. *Public Health Reports*, 1–6.

[2] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). Kratom drinks and consumption trends: Insights from Reddit. *Journal of Substance Use*, *31*(1), 124–132.

[3] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2025). Kratom beverages online: Marketing narratives, content, dosing, and potential risks. *Substance Use & Misuse*, 1–4.

Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics Pedagogy

[1] Chin, S., Io, K., Kırşanlı, F., & Perry, T. (2026). From cheating to learning: AI integration in introductory economics. *Journal of Economics Teaching*, *11*(2), 208–228.

Working Papers

[1] The Compensation of Conscience, with Sammy Zahran and Anders Fremstad. Under Review.

[2] Air Pollution and Crime: Heterogeneity by Offense Types and Exposure Intensity, with Salvador Lurbé and Prasiddha Shakya. Under Review.

[3] Loss or Gain from Separation? Wealth and Child Mental Health in Divorce Dynamics, with Solano Caffarena, Swarup Joshi, and Ashish Sedai.

[4] Maternal Lead Exposure and Birth Outcomes: Evidence from Natural Experiments in the Phase-out of Leaded Gasoline, with Sammy Zahran, Christopher Keyes, Yuulin An, and Susan Averett.

[5] The Effect of Leaded Gasoline on Infant Health: Evidence from NASCAR Fuel Transition, with Yuulin An and Sammy Zahran.

Work in Progress

[1] Lead Exposure and Heart-Disease Mortality in the United States, with Christopher Keyes, Bruce Lanphear, and Sammy Zahran.

[2] Tip Credit Effects on Employment, Earnings, and Establishments, with Vinicius Curti Cícero and Sammy Zahran.

[3] The Morning Advantage: Differential Returns to Sunlight Exposure on Well-being, with Sammy Zahran and Ray Miller.

[4] Excess Emissions and Infant Health: Evidence from Texas, with Susan Averett.

[5] Urban Heat Island and Birth Complications, with Yuulin An and Tim Komarek.

[6] Bringing Introductory Economics to Life: A Scaffolded Research Paper as Authentic Assessment in Introductory Economics, with Teresa Perry, Fatih Kırşanlı, and Kenese Io.

Teaching Experience

Lafayette College

ECON 215: Health Economics	FA 2025
ECON 346: Economic Development	FA 2024, SP 2025, FA 2025, SP 2026
ECON 251: Intermediate Microeconomics	FA 2023, SP 2024, FA 2024, SP 2025, SP 2026

Colorado State University

ECON 202: Principles of Microeconomics	FA 2017, FA 2019, SM 2020, FA 2021 SP 2022, FA 2022, SP 2023
ECON 204: Principles of Macroeconomics	SP 2018, FA 2018, SP 2019 SP 2020, FA 2020
ECON 306: Intermediate Microeconomics	FA 2021, SP 2022
ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomics	SP 2021
ECON 335: Introduction to Econometrics	SM 2019
ECON 460: Economic Development	FA 2021

Research Advising

Honors Thesis Advising

Daniel Colden ('26) - Economics and History (Primary Advisor)
Benjamin Risley ('26) - Government and Law, Economics (Second Reader)

Independent Study

Isabel Berkeley ('25)	Spring 2025
Xinyuan Liang ('27)	Spring 2025
Yi Luo ('26)	Spring 2025
Justin Fretz ('25)	Spring 2025

EXCEL Scholars/Bergh Fellows/Research Assistants

Fiorella Garcia Sanchez ('27)	Summer 2026
Yi Luo ('26)	Fall 2025
Ava Sydell ('27)	Summer 2025
Daniel Colden ('26)	Winter 2025
Naya Kurdy ('25)	Fall 2024, Spring 2025
Vanika Sok ('26)	Summer 2024, Fall 2024

College Service

Artificial Intelligence Club Advisor	Summer 2025 – Present
International Faculty & Staff Community of Practice Board Member	Spring 2025 – Present

Department Service

Scholarship Revision Working Group	Fall 2025 – Present
Co-organizer Department Honors Program	Fall 2024 – Present

Honors and Awards

Student Government Superior Teaching Awards Nominee, Lafayette College	2024
Graduate Research Assistantship, Colorado State University	2022
Competition Committee Member, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award	2022
Best Paper Award, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award	2021
Graduate Teaching Assistantship, Colorado State University	2017 – 2023
Colorado College Financial Aid Award	2013 – 2017
Davis United World College Scholars Scholarship Award	2013 – 2017
United World College of Southeast Asia Scholarship Award	2008 – 2013

Conferences

Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic	2026
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Seattle, WA	2025
Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL	2025
14th Annual Conference on Teaching and Research in Economic Education, Denver	2025
Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.	2024
70th NARSC Meetings, San Diego, CA	2023
The 3rd Annual Conference of the Western Social Science Association 2021 (virtual)	2021

Other Conference Activities

Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic, *Discussant*	2026
ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA, *Session Chair: Artificial Intelligence*	2026
Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C., *Discussant*	2024
70th NARSC Meetings, San Diego, CA, *Discussant*	2023

Workshops

7th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Orlando	2025
6th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Clemson	2024

Media Mentions

Huss, Phoebe. "Once given out at USC, this banned, opioid-like product is still cropping up in California." *CalMatters*, March 17, 2026.

Reddy, Sumathi. "What You Need to Know About Kratom." *Wall Street Journal*, August 16, 2025.

"Teresa Perry, PhD: Academic Paper on the Rise of Kratom Tonic Products." *Kratom Sobriety Podcast*, episode 46.

Invited Talks

Colorado College Economic Department Seminar Series	2026
Dickinson College Economic Department Seminar Series	2025
AI in Economics Seminar Series at Royal Holloway, University of London (virtual)	2025
Keynote Speaker, APIME Graduation Celebration at Lafayette College	2025
Faculty Features: A Faculty Scholarship & Creativity Roundtable, Lafayette College	2025
Asian Cultural Association at Lafayette College	2024, 2025
The Hanson Center for Inclusive STEM Education at Lafayette College	2024
University of Wyoming, Knox College, University of New Hampshire	2023

Skills and Credentials

Programming/Software

Proficient in: Python, R, Stata, MySQL, Git/GitHub

Certifications

Good Clinical Practice Training for Social and Behavioral Research, Tools for Data Science, Python for Data Science, Python for Data Science & AI, Data Science Methodology, Database & SQL for Data Science, Data Analysis with Python, Machine Learning with Python, Data Visualization with Python, Python Project for Data Science

Professional Affiliations

American Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists

Professional Service

Referee for: *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction* (2), *Regulation & Governance* (2), *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*, *Economics and Human Biology* (3), *Energy Economics* (4), *World Development*, *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities*

External reviewer: Ph.D. Dissertation at Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur